

FIELDCELL · DESIGN DECISIONS REGISTER

FieldCell design decisions register

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
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Source	docs/06-design-decisions.md @ uncommitted		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.3	2026-10-02	Amish Chadha	Amish approved the recommendations for all eight open decisions (FCL-DDR-003 accepted); moved to decisions made
0.2	2026-10-01	Amish Chadha	Budget treated as a value-engineering target
0.1	2026-10-01	Amish Chadha	Register opened with the open decisions of FCL-DDR-001 to 003 and the review note, items to confirm when parts are bought, and decisions made

FieldCell design decisions register

Every design decision still to be made, and every decision made, in one place. Each decision is argued in full in its decision record under `docs/decisions/` ; this register is the index Amish works from. The build plan (`docs/05-build-plan.md`) describes the design as it stands and does not list open decisions.

■ **Open decisions**

None. All open decisions were decided on 2026-10-02.

■ **To confirm when parts are bought**

Table 1. Items to confirm when parts are bought.

#	What to confirm	Why it matters	Source
1	The solar module is no larger than 1,380 x 680 mm, has Vmp of 36 V or more at standard test conditions, has a back that takes structural tape, and leads long enough to reach the electronics box	Sets the 10 mm rim on the wing frame and the charge headroom at 70 °C	FCL-DDR-003, P7; FCL-DDR-001, D3; FCL-CAL-001 [B4]
2	The wheel hub is about 60 mm long with a 20 mm bore and bearings	Sets the spacer collar length (37.5 mm) and the axle length (820 mm)	FCL-DDR-003, P3
3	The electronics box's mounting plate, its bosses, and the cut-out templates of the DC panel, GFCI and in-use cover, isolator, filter fan and exhaust filter	They set the cut-outs and the layout on the plate	FCL-DDR-003, P11
4	The inverter (about 270 x 210 x 110 mm) and charge controller (about 150 x 140 x 70 mm) fit the mounting plate with 10 mm between parts	The layout is drawn for these sizes	FCL-DDR-003, P11
5	The battery case has a flat end wall for two M25 glands 150 mm up, and room beside the pack for the class T fuse holder (about 60 x 50 x 45 mm)	The fuse must be within 150 mm of the positive terminal	FCL-DDR-003, P11, P12
6	The piano hinge leaves are about 26 x 1.5 mm and the knuckle no more than 8 mm across	The pin sits 4.5 mm above the panel face; a bigger knuckle needs more	FCL-DDR-003, P6
7	The over-centre latch and its keeper close on the 12 mm the model allows	Sets the tie bar length (731 mm)	FCL-DDR-003, P9
8	The inverter's derating at 45 °C, no-load draw of 10 W or less, and fan noise	R9, R4 and R11 rest on these figures	FCL-DDR-002, A4; FCL-CAL-001 [D6], [I2]
9	The pack's battery management system peak rating and the class T fuse curve cover about 118 A for a few seconds; charging blocked below 0 °C and above 45 °C	Surge with full DC load	FCL-CAL-001 [B2]
10	Supplier quotes for the pack, the wings and the inverter	They replace the indicative prices and show the real cost against the value-engineering target	FCL-DDR-002, A1

■ Value engineering

Value-engineering target: USD 2,100 (a hypothetical control target, not a limit). Estimated cost of the constructable design: USD 2,101 (USD 1 over the target). Main cost drivers and savings worth trying:

- The largest lines are the two PV wings (USD 460), the pack (USD 300) and the inverter (USD 220).
- Making the design buildable took the BOM from USD 2,051 to USD 2,101: frame steel +USD 12, wheel collars and linch pins +USD 5, outrigger brackets +USD 6, two latches fewer and new fixings -USD 6, cam straps and PV glands +USD 15, shade uprights +USD 9 and tie bars +USD 9.
- The USD 1 gap is well inside the accuracy of indicative prices. Supplier quotes for the pack, wings and inverter are the first saving to try.

- Webbing straps with cam buckles in place of the tie bars were the other place to look for a small saving; the tie bars were kept on 2026-10-02.

■ Decisions made

Table 2. Decisions made.

Date	Decision	Decided by	Record
2026-09-25	TRL 2 review items D1 to D8: 25.6 V 50 Ah pack, fixed east-west wings at 15° as the cart walls, 24 V class panels in parallel, 120 V 60 Hz first, welded steel frame and flat-free tyres, SwapCell as a future variant only, budget held until quotes, disaster response first	Amish: "proceed with all of your recommendations across all batches. Make sure we don't proceed to TRL 4 on any of them."	FCL-DDR-001
2026-09-25	Budget raised to \$2,100; R6 limit relaxed to 75 kg; thermostat filter fan; reflective sun shade; 20 mm hinge spacer; "peak sun hours" read as global horizontal irradiation; heavy parts low and over the axle	Amish: "i accept all your recommendations, go with them across all repos."	FCL-DDR-002
2026-09-25	TRL 4 on hold: no building, testing or purchasing	Amish, same instruction as D1 to D8	FCL-DDR-001
2026-09-26	FieldCell chosen for the first batch of product renders	Amish (words not recorded)	docs/ REVIEW.md , session 2026-09-26
2026-09-30	Make the design physically buildable while drawing the build plan; record outstanding decisions in this register, not in the build plan. The changes made under this instruction (FCL-DDR-003) are open for Amish's review (Table 1, item 1)	Amish: "If you are realising that the design cannot be built as per concept - fix the design assumptions to match and be physically feasible as you draw the illustrations." and "don't log outstanding decisions in this build plan - that is not the place for it. that should be in a separate design document logged and named as such"	FCL-DDR-003 (Draft)
2026-10-02	Design for construction accepted: the changes P1 to P13 as made (open item 1)	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	FCL-DDR-003, Table 1
2026-10-02	Mass and pull: steel frame and flat-free tyres kept; R6 set at 82 kg and the R7 grass pull at 160 N (sharpened from the 80 kg first proposed, to keep a margin); the prototype is weighed at TRL 4 and moves to the bolted aluminium frame (option b) if it is over 82 kg (open item 2)	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	FCL-DDR-003, A1; FCL-CAL-001 [E3], [E5], [F1]; FCL- REQ-001 R6 and R7
2026-10-02	Stowed wings held by the two tie bars with over-centre latches, as modelled (option a) (open item 3)	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	FCL-DDR-003, A3
2026-10-02	The shade lifts off on four wing bolts to open the battery case, for service only (option a) (open item 4)	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	FCL-DDR-003, A4
2026-10-02			FCL-DDR-001, O1

Date	Decision	Decided by	Record
	Seek a responder organization now, for a paper review of the deployment sequence and load profile only; first candidate to approach a US volunteer disaster response organization such as Team Rubicon, since the first build is 120 V 60 Hz (open item 5)	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	
2026-10-02	Positioning: FieldCell is the mobile field-site unit (PV only, 1 kW AC, one-person cart, own 25.6 V pack), PowerBox the household outage unit (multi-input, indoor, SwapCell pack) and SwapCell the shared pack standard; one paragraph saying so goes in each README (open item 6)	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	FCL-DDR-001, O2
2026-10-02	No AC charger; the vehicle 12 V input is left out of the first prototype and may be offered later as a DC-to-DC charging option if the responder review asks for it (open item 7)	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	FCL-DDR-001, O3
2026-10-02	Appearance model rebuilt from the constructable model and re-rendered on Amish's Mac, with the clear side window as a render aid only (option a) (open item 8)	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	docs/ REVIEW.md , sessions 2026-09-26 and 2026-10-01; FCL-DDR-003